

When you insert a function as one of the arguments within another function in Excel, it's called nesting functions. For example, you can nest an AVERAGE function within an IF function if you want to base the logical test on a calculated average.

The syntax for nested functions will vary greatly, as the combinations for combining functions is nearly limitless. Excel allows you to nest up to 64 functions.

Our worksheet shows six food items – **3 healthy and 3 junk food** – and how many students chose each for their tiffin over 5 days.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1									
2			Apples	Bananas	Grapes	Chocolate	Chips	Kurkure	
3		Monday	25	20	20	24	24	27	
4		Tuesday	10	10	20	25	45	30	
5		Wednesday	30	20	10	30	25	25	
6		Thursday	20	20	25	42	27	6	
7		Friday	25	24	30	34	17	10	
8		Average	22	18.8	21	31	27.6	19.6	
9									

We want to know how many more students, on average, chose junk food instead of healthy food. To make that calculation we will need the following information. To answer the question without nested functions, you could use multiple additional cells and the formulas in the example below:

Average of each food: =AVERAGE(C3:C7), =AVERAGE(D3:D7), =AVERAGE(E3:E7), and so on

Average of each kind of food: =SUM(F8:H8) & =SUM(B8:D8)

Difference between healthy average and junk average: =C11-C10

C13									
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1									
2			Apples	Bananas	Grapes	Chocolate	Chips	Kurkure	
3		Monday	25	20	20	24	24	27	
4		Tuesday	10	10	20	25	45	30	
5		Wednesday	30	20	10	30	25	25	
6		Thursday	20	20	25	42	27	6	
7		Friday	25	24	30	34	17	10	
8		Average	22	18.8	21	31	27.6	19.6	
9									
10		Average Healthy	61.8						
11		Average Junk	78.2						
12		Difference	-16.4						